Background Scheme — Leish! Aesthetic Marketplace

Document	05 — Background, Gradient & Elevation System
Version	1.0
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Companion	04-design-brief.md
Source of truth	`src/index.css` (`@theme`) + patterns observed across `src/components/*`

Concept — "Espresso Gallery." The interface is a darkened gallery: a warm near-black room (`#0F0D0A`) in which photography, gold accents and type are the light. Backgrounds step up in *warm* increments — never gray, never blue — and depth is built from surface steps, hairline borders, scrims and a single soft gold glow. No hard drop shadows, no pure black, no pure white.

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1. The Elevation Ladder

Six rungs, each a warm-dark step. **Every surface in the app must map to exactly one rung.**

Rung	Token	Hex	Use for
0 · Canvas	`--color-canvas`	`#0F0D0A`	Page background, empty wells
1 · Recessed	—	`#0E0C09` / `#100E0A`	Inputs wells inside modals, gradient endpoints, ba
2 · Panel	`--color-elevated`	`#14110C` (`#110F0B`–`#15120D`)	Modals, drawers, sticky bars, feature panels
3 · Card / Surface	`--color-surface`	`#221E16` (`#17140F`–`#1F1B14`)	Cards, sub-sections, inputs, secondary buttons
4 · Chip	`--color-chip`	`#2B251B`	Chips, pills, badges, hovered fills
5 · Line	`--color-line`	`#3E3628`	Hairline borders only (1–2px), dividers

Rules

- Depth goes *up* by rung + a hairline border — not by shadow alone.
- Never place rung 3 on rung 3 (no "card in card" of equal value); step down to rung 1/2 for insets.
- Never use `#000000` as a surface (black is reserved for photo scrims, §4) and never `#FFFFFF` as a fill (white is text/`fg` only).

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2. Observed Neutral Ramp (de-facto tokens)

Values actually rendered in the codebase today, ordered dark → light:

`#0E0C09`	recessed deep	`#14110C`	panel	`#1F1B14`	raised row
`#0F0D0A`	canvas	`#15120D`	panel warm	`#201C15`	avatar well
`#100E0A`	dialog bg	`#17140F`	card inset	`#221E16`	surface / border
`#110F0B`	feature card	`#18150F`	input fill	`#2B251B`	chip
`#12100C`	inset row	`#1A1711`	banner panel	`#3E3628`	line
		`#1D1912`	panel gradient mid		

⚠ **Debt:** these ~16 hexes are scattered as arbitrary values (`bg-[#17140F]`). They collapse into **5 tokens** — see §8 (Codification).

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3. Layer Types

3.1 Base layer

```
body { background-color: var(--color-canvas); color: var(--color-fg); }
```

Every view roots on canvas. Sections separate with spacing + hairlines, **not** with alternating background bands.

3.2 Panel gradient (hero / feature panels)

Directional warm sweep that gives large panels a subtle light source:

Variant	CSS	Used by
A · horizontal	`linear-gradient(to right, #15120D 0%, #1D1912 50%, #100E0A 100%)`	`LookbookStudio` hero panel
B · horizontal (short)	`to right, #17140F → #100E0A`	`ClientPortal` header banner
C · diagonal	`to bottom right, #18150F → #100E0A`	`ClientPortal` summary card
D · diagonal (deep)	`to bottom right, #17140F → #0E0C09`	`AIStylist` result card
E · horizontal (wide)	`to right, #14110D → #1D1912 → #100E0A`	`ProviderDashboard` footer CTA
F · banner	`to right, #1A1711 → #100E0A`	`ProviderDashboard` promo strip

Rules: delta between endpoints ≤ ~15% luminance (it must read as *lighting*, not as a striped design); always paired with a 1px `#574D3C`/30–40% border when it signals importance; never behind body text longer than 3 lines.

3.3 Glow orb (the signature motif)

```
<div class="absolute top-10 right-10 w-96 h-96 rounded-full
            bg-[#574D3C]/15 blur-3xl pointer-events-none"></div>
```

- **Color:** `--color-accent #574D3C` at **10–18% opacity** (rarely 20%).
- **Blur:** `blur-3xl` (64px) minimum; `blur-2xl` for smaller instances.
- **Placement:** anchored to a corner, half-off the container (`-mt-10 -mr-10`), `overflow-hidden` on the parent.
- **Count: max 1 per view.** Seen in `App.tsx` hero (96×96) and `LookbookStudio` (72×72).
- **Always** `pointer-events-none`; decorative → `aria-hidden`.
- **Never** place under running text — only under headings, empty space, or media.

3.4 Frosted overlay (floating chrome over content)

```
<!-- nav -->
class="sticky border-b bg-canvas/95 backdrop-blur-md"
<!-- dropdown -->
class="border border-line bg-elevated p-2 shadow-2xl"
<!-- pill over photo -->
class="bg-black/70 border border-white/20 backdrop-blur-md"
```

Element	Fill	Blur	Border
Sticky nav	`canvas/95`	`backdrop-blur-md`	`border-b line` (accent-tinted when scrolled)
Dropdown/menu	`elevated` (opaque)	none needed	`1px line`, `shadow-2xl`
Chip over photo	`black/60–80`	`backdrop-blur-md`	`white/10–20` or `accent/50`
Modal backdrop	`black/80`	`backdrop-blur-md`	—
Hero search dropdown	`canvas/95`	`backdrop-blur-xl`	`#3E3628`

Rule: blur only on elements that *float over scrollable content*; opaque fills everywhere else (blur is the most expensive item on this list — see §7).

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4. Scrims (photo darkening for legibility)

Backgrounds over photography guarantee text contrast. Four recipes, all currently in use:

Recipe	CSS	Purpose
Bottom fade (strong)	`to top, #0F0D0A 0%, rgba(15,13,10,.6) 50%, transparent 100%`	Hero (`via 60%`)
Bottom fade (cards)	`to top, #0F0D0A/85 → transparent`	`SalonCard`, gallery bases
Bottom fade (subtle)	`to top, #0F0D0A 0%, /40 40%, transparent`	`MUACard`, `SalonDetails`, `LookbookStudio`
Left rail	`to right, #0F0D0A/95 → /50 → transparent`	Hero text column
Black cap	`to top, black/80 → transparent`	Small caption chips on imagery

Recipe	CSS	Purpose
Image dim	`filter: brightness(0.38)`	Hero photo base state (before sc

Rules

- Text over photography sits on **at least one scrim**; if copy is longer than a headline, use *two* (bottom + side).
- Scrim color is **always canvas** `#0F0D0A` (never pure black) so the fade melts into the page; `black/` is allowed only for tiny caption chips.
- Keep fades ≥ 40% of the image height — a hard cut reads as a rectangle, not light.
- After scrims, re-verify contrast: body over image ≥ 4.5:1, large/mono labels ≥ 3:1.

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5. Accent & CTA Gradients

Name	Gradient	Hover	Where
Gold primary	`to right, #574D3C → #463D2E`	`brightness-110`	Auth submit, AI Advisor CTA
Gold → crimson	`to right, #574D3C → #751311` / `→ #7F1513`	`#B12220 → #8E1917`	Lookbook ”Book This Look” (the c
Gold tint	`bg-[#574D3C]/5 · /10 · /15 · /20`	—	Selected rows, info callouts, badg
Gold border	`border-[#574D3C]/30 · /40 · /50 · /60`	solid `#574D3C` on active	Active chips, selected cards, focu
Gold shadow	`shadow-lg shadow-[#574D3C]/25`	—	Primary buttons (tinted glow, not

Rules

- One gradient CTA per viewport; flat `bg-accent` elsewhere.
- Gold-tint fills are the *only* ”highlight” language — do not introduce blue/green selection states (emerald is reserved for success).
- Crimson appears **once** per flow at most; it signals the decisive moment (booking commitment).

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6. Screen-by-Screen Background Map

Screen	Base	Panels
Explore / Hero	canvas	photo + `brightness-.38` + bottom & left scrims
Listing grids	canvas	cards `bg-canvas` + `border-#221E16`, bottom fade on media
SalonDetails	canvas	gallery bottom fade; inset rows `#17140F`
BookingModal	`black/80` + blur backdrop	panel `#14110C`, steps inset `#574D3C/5–10`
AuthModal / ProfileModal	`black/80` + `backdrop-blur-md`	dialog `#100E0A`, inset `#17140F`
AI Lookbook	canvas	variant A panel gradient + glow orb; result card `#110F0E`
AI Advisor	canvas	form `#14110C`, result variant D gradient
Client Portal	canvas	variant B/C banners, rows `#12100C`, `#1F1B14`
Provider Dashboard	canvas	variant E/F banners, tables on canvas
Workspace Hub	canvas	repeated cards `bg-canvas` + `border-#221E16`, inputs `#18150F`
Map	canvas	map container `bg-canvas`, `border-#221E16`

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7. Accessibility & Performance

Contrast

- Body text on canvas `#0F0D0A`: **15.4:1** · muted `#C4B8A4` 9.9:1 · dim `#B8A77A` 8.2:1 · accent-text `#C4AD78` 8.9:1.
- Muted, dim, subtle and accent-text tiers are now measured at **≥4.5:1 on every dark rung**, including chip and line, so labels remain readable when components change elevation.
- Primary actions use the dark `#574D3C` fill with `on-primary #E6E5E4`; the hover fill `#6B5F4A` also remains ≥4.5:1. Do not replace this fill with bright gold behind light text.

- Semantic status colors use a high-contrast foreground plus a tinted surface and 3:1 border: success (emerald), warning (champagne), danger (crimson), and info (blue).
- **Watch:** gold-tint fills (`/5–/20`) reduce effective contrast — re-check status or `fg-muted` text inside translucent panels; drop to `fg` if < 4.5:1.

Performance

- `blur-3xl` on a 384px orb and `backdrop-blur` on sticky chrome force repaints on scroll — acceptable, but:
  - max **1 orb + 1 blurred sticky element** per screen;
  - `pointer-events-none` + `will-change: auto` on orbs;
  - avoid `backdrop-blur` on elements that resize during scroll (tables/accordions).
- Scrims are pure gradients → GPU-cheap; prefer them to overlay divs with `opacity`.
- `prefers-reduced-motion`: orbs stay (static), but any orb *pulse/fade* animation is disabled.

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8. Codification Plan (debt cleanup)

Problem: ~16 raw hexes and 20+ bespoke gradient strings live as Tailwind arbitrary values, duplicated per component.

Proposal — add to `src/index.css @theme`:

```
--color-recessed: #100E0A;   /* rung 1 */
--color-panel:    #14110C;   /* rung 2  (alias of elevated) */
--color-inset:    #17140F;   /* rung 3 dark inset */
```

And promote the recurring recipes to utilities:

```
@layer utilities {
  .bg-panel-gradient      { background-image: linear-gradient(to right, #15120D, #1D1912, #100E0A); }
  .bg-panel-gradient-dim  { background-image: linear-gradient(to bottom right, #17140F, #0E0C09); }
  .bg-scrim-bottom        { background-image: linear-gradient(to top, #0F0D0A, rgba(15,13,10,.6) 50%, transparent); }
  .bg-scrim-bottom-soft   { background-image: linear-gradient(to top, rgba(15,13,10,.85), transparent); }
  .bg-scrim-left          { background-image: linear-gradient(to right, rgba(15,13,10,.95), rgba(15,13,10,.5) 55%, transparent); }
  .glow-orb               { border-radius: 9999px; background: rgb(87 77 60 / .15); filter: blur(64px); pointer-events: none; }
}
```

Migration order: Hero → Lookbook → ClientPortal/ProviderDashboard banners → modals → grids → WorkspaceHub (largest count, lowest risk). Verify each screen visually after conversion; the change is a rename, not a redesign.

> Note: `src/lib/design-tokens.ts` documents a *different* palette and is imported nowhere. Either regenerate it from `@theme` or delete it — two sources of truth is how drift starts.

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9. Do & Don't

[OK] Do	[NO] Don't
Step elevation with the 6-rung ladder	Invent a new near-black hex per component
Hairline `#3E3628` borders for definition	Heavy gray drop shadows (`shadow-black/50`)
One glow orb per view, corner-anchored, ≤18%	Multiple orbs, orbs behind body text
Canvas-colored scrims over photography	Pure-black full-image overlays / unreadable text on photos
≤15% luminance delta on panel gradients	Loud multi-stop brand gradients on sections
Gold tint `#574D3C/5–20` as the only highlight	Blue selection, purple focus, rainbow status colors
`backdrop-blur` only on floating chrome	Blur on scrolling cards or full-page backdrops
`pointer-events-none` + `aria-hidden` on decoration	Interactive elements inside decorative layers

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10. Acceptance Checklist

- ☐ Every surface maps to one of the 6 rungs (no orphan hexes after §8 migration).

- [ ] Exactly one glow orb per view; decorative layers are `pointer-events-none` + `aria-hidden`.
- [ ] All text over photography sits on a scrim and re-passes contrast.
- [ ] One gradient CTA per viewport; crimson appears at most once per flow.
- [ ] No `#000` surfaces, no `#FFF` fills, no cool-gray neutrals.
- [ ] Panel gradients ≤15% luminance delta.
- [ ] `backdrop-blur` limited to sticky nav, modals, and photo-floating chips.
- [ ] Raw hex count in `src/` reduced to tokens/utilities (grep gate: `bg-\[#` returns only approved values).